

league and became the deserving winners.

However, behind the success of Kochi Blue Tigers was months of meticulous planning by head coach Raiphy Vincent Gomez and his team. From picking the players in the auction to assigning specific roles to them, Raiphy had planned everything in detail. The players understood their roles and executed them to perfection.

The opening gambit of Vinoop Manoharan fired Blue Tigers to explosive starts. Rookies like Mohammed Ashique turned into match winners as Kochi scripted some great wins in the tournament. The only team which could match Kochi was last year's defending champion Aries Kollam Sailors.

The Sailors hit form in the latter part of the tournament and was expected to be a worthy rival for Blue Tigers in the final. Skipper Sachin Baby, despite not being able to replicate the first season's form was still a force and the explosive Vishnu Vinod was a match winner.

The final was expected to be a close affair but Kochi's myriad strength in finding the perfect fit for every challenge saw Vinoop and P.S. Jerin turn



All rounder Akhil Scaria was chosen as the player of the tournament

heroes with the bat and ball respectively. Kochi's indomitable spirit saw it dethrone Kollam Sailors.

Standout moments

The KCL like in the previous season brought unheralded players into



limelight and at the same time enhanced the reputation of few.

Salman Nizar's five sixes, Aji-nas' hat-trick were the standout moments of the league that also saw some nail-biting finishes. Akhil Scaria who performed consistently with bat and ball was chosen as the player of the tournament. Ahammed Imran showed he was a player with a bright future.

The second edition of KCL received an overwhelming response in social media, gaining over 50,000 followers on various platforms.

The official promo film featuring Mohanlal crossed two million views on Instagram within 36 hours. The next edition of KCL promises to be even bigger with plans to spread it out to other districts.



Salman Nizar lit up the tournament by slamming five sixes in an over from Basil Thampi



KCA president Jayesh George and secretary Vinod S. Kumar honour women achievers during the launch of the Kerala Women's Cricket League.

PHOTOS: NIRMAL HARINDRAN



The spectators enjoying action at the Greenfield stadium